



SOLDIER OF FORTUNE

DOUBLE II HELIX

The ultra violent tactical shooter from Raven is back!

A new and insidious threat has risen in the form of a bio-terrorist organisation and their two-pronged Gemini Virus. You take control as John Mullins, weapons specialist, anti-terrorist mercenary and military consultant, off on a transcontinental mission to stop the terrorists and destroy the virus before it's unleashed on humanity. Raven has done a fantastic job of utilising the *Quake III Arena* engine and GHOUL II technology for ultra realistic

damage modelling. With 36 damage zones and 16 dismemberment zones, you're assured of intense, action-packed, bowel-turning, graphic violence!

Camouflage your intentions

The tactical advantage or disadvantage you gain from the lush vegetation adds a new dimension to the game. Mullins can use camouflage techniques to merge into the surroundings. You stay in a concealed position with your sniper scope to the eye, lining up that perfect head shot, then put the enemy down with a gentle squeeze on the trigger.

Be wary

But be wary of the AI of the enemies—they'll surprise you with their tactics and survival instincts. Enemies will duck around corners and reload their weapons.

If you shoot a gun out of an enemy's hands, he won't just run away. He'll go looking for another weapon and come back to get you. If you rely heavily on sniping, the enemy soldiers will wise up to it and try to move in closer for the kill, while effectively using the terrain and advanced criss-cross movement techniques.

Slow and stealthy

There are several stealth missions in the game; most of them will prove to be frustrating if you don't use stealth tactics. Sneak up behind the guards and hit them with the pistol using secondary fire. But don't merely knock them unconscious, because they'll wake up. Instead, finish them off with the rifle butt, pistol whip or knife. When you see the pool of blood, you know they're dead and won't

be setting off any alarms anymore. Also, try walking instead of running, or disable 'Always Run'. The enemy AI can hear you if you're noisy and you're quieter while walking or crawling.



Use foliage to your advantage to creep up on enemies and give them a hot lead injection!

Want more gameplay?

Okay, so you've blasted your way through all 55 levels and want something more. There is an in-game mission generator that allows you to customise your own levels of play. You can choose the mission type, location, time of day, difficulty and time limit. And *SOFII* features great multiplayer action with various modes like Deathmatch, Team Deathmatch, Capture the Flag, Elimination and Infiltration. ■

SIRIRAM SHARMA

Tweaks for Maximising Single Player Performance

SOFII is a system hog—you need at least a 16 MB video card to run it. Bring down the console and type `cg_drawFPS 1` to view the frame rates. You need at least a frame rate of 30 to 40 fps to play it decently. If you find your system lagging, try the following:

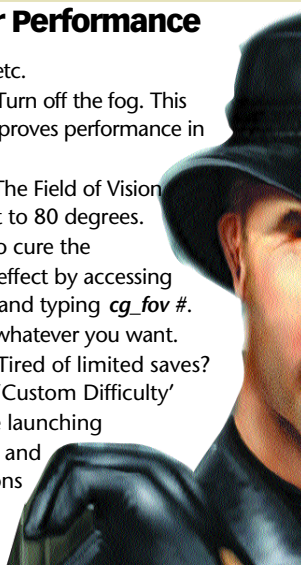
- Run Scandisk and Disk Defragmenter utilities to optimise your hard drive. Make sure you have a large page/swap file available for the game to use.
- Play the game at a resolution of 640x480. Cranking the game up higher than 800x600 will make for huge performance slowdowns and extremely long load times.
- Set sound sample quality to low if you have an onboard or built-in soundcard.
- Disable Decals, like bullet holes,

blast marks, etc.

Turn off the fog. This drastically improves performance in some areas.

The Field of Vision of *SOFII* is set to 80 degrees. Set it to 90 to cure the 'zoomed in' effect by accessing the console, and typing `cg_fov #`. Set the # to whatever you want.

Tired of limited saves? Go into the 'Custom Difficulty' menu before launching a new game and set the options to your liking.



Cheats Galore

You can bring down the console in *SOFII* by pressing and holding the [SHIFT] key and then pressing the tilde [~] key. Type `sv_cheats 1` (it is case sensitive) and press [Enter]. The cheat codes are essentially the same as in *Quake III: Arena*. The main ones are:

God Mode: `god`
 Noclip Mode: `noclip`
 Get all weapons: `give all`
 Enemies can't see you: `notarget`
 Speed up or slow down the game: `timescale x`
 Warp directly to a map: `map <mapname>`